

Hypothesis and Pivot Framework 0.11

Hypothesis & Pivot Log

Core Hypotheses

H1 — Customers Have a Painful Enough Problem

Hypothesis

Government agencies, mining companies, and researchers in Ghana struggle with fragmented mining intelligence and are willing to pay for centralized geospatial mining analytics.

What “Disproved” Looks Like

After:

10–15 interviews

multiple demos

pricing conversations

if:

fewer than 30% express strong operational pain

nobody requests pilots

nobody discusses budgets or procurement

then H1 is likely false or poorly targeted.

Validation Goal

Obtain:

3 LOIs OR

1 paid pilot OR

multiple procurement discussions

H2 — Customer Acquisition Is Economically Viable

Hypothesis

We can acquire institutional customers through:

partnerships

direct outreach

mining conferences

LinkedIn

WhatsApp networking

at a sustainable acquisition cost.

What “Disproved” Looks Like

After:

3–5 months

outreach to 50+ organizations

if:

customer acquisition cost becomes extremely high

sales cycles are excessively long

outreach response rates remain very low

then acquisition strategy may not scale.

Validation Goal

Target:

response rate >10%

at least 3 serious demo requests

at least 1 conversion path within 90 days

H3 — The Platform Has a Defensible Advantage

Hypothesis

An African-focused mining intelligence platform with localized GIS datasets, regional partnerships, and ECOWAS expansion capability can build a defensible moat.

What “Disproved” Looks Like

If:

global GIS vendors easily replicate the concept

local data access is not exclusive
customers prefer generic existing tools
no differentiation emerges during interviews
then the moat is weak.

Validation Goal

Customers repeatedly mention:
lack of Africa-specific mining intelligence
fragmented regional data
need for localized monitoring tools

Pivot Triggers

Pivot Trigger for H1 Failure

If H1 is false after 10–15 interviews:

Pivot:

Shift customer segment from:
regulators/governments
to:
mining consultancies
exploration firms
ESG/compliance organizations

Pivot Trigger for H2 Failure

If acquisition costs are too high:

Pivot:

Change acquisition channel from:
direct enterprise sales
to:
partnerships with universities

mining associations

government-backed pilot programs

Pivot Trigger for H3 Failure

If defensibility is weak:

Pivot:

Build moat around:

proprietary African datasets

regional compliance workflows

mining ESG monitoring

localized intelligence reports

instead of general GIS mapping.

Predefined Pivot Options

Pivot Option 1 — ESG & Environmental Monitoring Platform

New Focus

Environmental and illegal mining monitoring.

Why This Pivot Makes Sense

Governments and NGOs increasingly need:

ESG tracking

environmental compliance

illegal mining visibility

This could become:

compliance-focused SaaS

donor/government funded

Pivot Option 2 — Mining Data & Intelligence API Platform

New Focus

Become the infrastructure layer providing:

mining datasets

APIs

analytics feeds

instead of full dashboards.

Why This Pivot Makes Sense

Many companies already have dashboards but lack:

structured African mining data

standardized APIs

regional intelligence feeds

Pivot Review Date

Recommended Pivot Review Date

August 15, 2026

Why This Timing?

By then you should have:

10–20 interviews

landing page metrics

pilot conversations

pricing feedback

acquisition data

Enough signal to evaluate:

continue

narrow

pivot

pause

Kill-Switch Criteria

Consider Pausing or Pivoting If:

After 90–120 days:

no meaningful interview traction

no pilot interest

no data partnerships

no willingness to pay

acquisition channels fail

then the original thesis may not be strong enough.

Weekly Learnings Log